

Meeting 7: Presenting Your Research

Preparing the conference presentation
Bachelor Project 2025–2026

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Today's agenda

1. Where we are
2. The 10-minute presentation: structure and timing
3. Designing effective slides
4. Delivery
5. Assessment: presentation and peer review
6. Peer-feedback pairs, and what is due Tuesday 9 June
7. Discussion

One plenary today. We work through the conference presentation, then open the floor for questions.

Where we are

A7 comes back today with written feedback on Canvas. The calendar from here is tight, so plan around it.

- **Next week is the conference:** Thursday 11 June. Each of you gives a 10-minute presentation, and it is graded.
- **This Tuesday 9 June** you send two files to your paired peer: your slides and your current paper.
- You also receive your peer's paper, and you bring written feedback to the conference.

Important

The presentation is short and graded. Today we focus on using the 10 minutes well.

The 10-minute presentation

What the presentation must cover

The presentation covers five things, in this order:

1. The **research question**, and why it matters
2. The **theory and design** behind it
3. How you **collected the data**
4. Your **main findings**
5. The **implications**

It is not a tour of the whole thesis. It is the central argument in compressed form. It is assessed on clarity and the red thread, not on the volume of content.

Two organising principles

One message

- If the audience remembers one sentence, what should it be?
- Build the entire presentation around that sentence.
- Write it down before building any slides.

One slide per minute

- Roughly nine slides for ten minutes.
- Beyond that, you will rush the findings.
- Denser slides do not create more time.

Tip

Decide your one-sentence take-away first, then build the presentation around it.

A 10-minute structure

Roughly one slide per minute. The findings take two.

Slide	Content	Time
1	Title: your name, thesis title, the RQ in one line	0:30
2	Motivation: the puzzle, and why it matters	1:00
3	Research question and sub-questions	1:00
4	Theory: the one framework you actually use	1:30
5	Method and data: design, case, what you collected	1:30
6–7	Findings: one or two key results, a figure each	3:00
8	The answer to the RQ, and the implications	1:00
9	One take-away, then thank you	0:30
Total		≈10:00

Use this as a template. If a section will not fit the time, that is a signal to cut, not to talk faster.

Prioritising the findings

The two findings slides are half the presentation. Weak talks lose them by spending too long on theory.

- Show **one or two results** that answer the RQ, not all of them.
- **One figure or table per slide**, stating what it shows *and* what it means.
- A result you do not interpret does not belong in the presentation.
- Detail belongs in the paper; the presentation carries the main result.

If you reach minute five and are still on theory, move to the findings.

Designing effective slides

Keep the slides minimal

- **Keywords, not sentences.** The audience reads faster than you speak, so a full paragraph on screen means they stop listening to you.
- **One idea per slide.** If it needs two titles, it is two slides.
- **Readable from the back row:** large type, high contrast, generous white space.
- **Figures exported clean,** not screenshots of R, Stata, SPSS, or Excel. The same rule applies as in the thesis.
- **Label every figure:** axes with units, one clear point per chart.

Cramped versus clean

Cramped slide

- Full sentences the presenter reads aloud
- Six or seven bullets at once
- A screenshot pasted from a notebook
- Three separate ideas, no clear point
- Title that just says “Findings”

Clean slide

- Three or four keywords
- One figure with labelled axes
- The message written into the title
- Space around everything
- Title that states the point: “Control tightens after 2021”

Put the main point of the slide in its title. The body is the evidence for it.

Delivery

Delivery

- **Do not read the slides.** Speak to the audience and let the slides support you.
- **Rehearse aloud at least twice, with a timer.** Reading it silently is not rehearsal.
- **Prepare the opening and the closing in full.** They carry the most weight, so do not improvise them.
- **Look at the audience, not the screen.** Stand, and do not present from behind the laptop.
- **Use a pointer** to direct attention on each figure.

Timing and questions

Timing

- Know which slide to reach by minute five.
- If behind, cut detail, not the findings.
- Finish on the take-away slide.

If you run over, the chair will stop you. Plan to finish with time to spare.

Questions

- Answer the question asked, briefly.
- “I did not test that” is an acceptable answer.
- Treat peer feedback as input, not a verdict.

Assessment

Presentation: assessment criteria

Each criterion is scored 1 to 5.

#	Criterion	Score
1	The research question is clearly presented and motivated	/5
2	A concise but clear overview of the design (theory and methods)	/5
3	Findings focused on the main results, with clear relevance to the RQ	/5
4	A clear red thread: RQ, theory, methods, findings, conclusions	/5
5	A good balance between the different parts	/5
Presentation subtotal		/25

Criteria 4 and 5 reward a coherent, well-paced presentation. Attempting to include everything tends to weaken both.

Peer review: assessment criteria

Your written feedback to your paired peer is also scored, 1 to 5 each.

#	Criterion	Score
1	Clearly points out what you see as the main strengths	/5
2	Clearly points out the main points for improvement	/5
3	Suggestions for improvement are clear and actionable	/5
Review subtotal		/15

A review is assessed on its usefulness to the presenter, not on how positive it is.

Writing useful peer feedback

- **Identify the main strength specifically:** which argument or result was convincing, and why.
- **Identify the main point for improvement,** with a concrete fix.
- **Make suggestions actionable:** what to change, and where.
- **Engage with the content,** not the visual style.

Example: “Your second finding on algorithmic control was the clearest part. The move from method to findings was abrupt; one transition sentence naming the sub-question it answers would address that. The theory slide listed three frameworks where the presentation used only one, so I would cut the other two.”

Pairs and deadlines

What is due Tuesday 9 June

- Send your paired peer **two files**: your presentation slides and your current paper.
- You receive theirs in return. Read it, and bring written feedback to the conference.
- The exchange is **mutual**: the person you send to is the person who reviews you, and whom you review.

Important

Deadline to send slides and paper to your peer: Tuesday 9 June. The conference is Thursday 11 June.

Group 16a: pairs

You present Thursday 11 June, 12:30–13:45

You	Send slides + paper to
Kate Domnikova	Lena Minch
Lea Geciova	Pauline Castelein
Vince Kromberg	Bartek Korolec
Francis van Luyn	Lea Capelle

Each pairing is mutual: the peer listed also sends you their paper to review. Email addresses for your partner are on Canvas.

Group 16b: pairs

You present Thursday 11 June, 13:45–15:00

You	Send slides + paper to
Anand Esponda	Ana van Geloven Coello
Kseniya Sidorenko	Darta Plato
Lolo Reysen	Lu Samper Ibars
Daniel Ugarte Valdiviezo	Amalia Krosdorf

Each pairing is mutual: the peer listed also sends you their paper to review. Email addresses for your partner are on Canvas.

Timeline to submission

Date	What is due
Tuesday 9 June	Send slides and paper to your paired peer
Thursday 11 June	Conference: 10-minute presentations and peer feedback (graded)
Tuesday 16 June	Draft manuscript due
Thursday 18 June	Individual 1:1 consultations (Meeting 9)
Thursday 25 June	Final thesis, 23:59 (hard deadline)

The conference and the peer review are the final assessed checkpoints before the manuscript. Use the presentation to test whether your full argument holds together.

Discussion

Key references

On scientific presentations:

- Alley, M. (2013). *The Craft of Scientific Presentations* (2nd ed.). Springer.
- Doumont, J.-L. (2009). *Trees, Maps, and Theorems: Effective Communication for Rational Minds*. Principiae.

On slide design:

- Reynolds, G. (2011). *Presentation Zen* (2nd ed.). New Riders.

Questions?

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